

INDIA'S RACE TOWARDS A CLEAN, NET ZERO FUTURE

Climate change isn't a challenge for tomorrow. It's an imperative for today—solved only through a global integration of will and skill. Businesses, governments, investors and society need to work together to harness bold new ways to accelerate the race to zero. India surely has started on a strong note.

In November 2021, at the 26th Conference of Parties (COP) to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), the Honourable Prime Minister (PM) of India, Shri Narendra Modi, pledged that India would cut its emissions to net zero by 2070, and set important milestones to prioritize on this path. The PM envisages the country's carbon emissions to be reduced by 1 billion tonnes by 2010. India's carbon emissions relative to its GDP is to be curbed by 45% from 2005 levels.

With India on a high trajectory growth path, these objectives need to be met without compromising on the nation's energy needs. Top Indian corporations are increasing their sustainability quotient through investments in bettering operational sustainability through increased efficiency and responsible procurement of materials to upgrading disclosures.

The transport sector accounts for a quarter of total emissions, out of which road transport accounts for three-quarters of transport emissions (and 15% of total global CO2 emissions). Passenger vehicles are the largest chunk of this, releasing about 45% of CO2. India is the fifth-largest global car manufacturer with one of the highest compound annual growth rates of vehicle registration. The annual car sales in India are projected to increase from the current 3.5 million to about 10.5 million — a three times increase — by 2030, which will increase exposure to vehicular exhaust emissions.

However India is enthusing automobile companies to bring in electric vehicles and move towards hydrogen-powered automobiles. The PM is betting on EVs to drive a silent revolution in India, helping reduce carbon emissions. India has vowed to produce 50% of its electricity from non-fossil sources by 2030 and lower GDP emissions by 45%. EVs have an important role to play to reach these goals.

Indian Energy companies are gearing up to support the change. Take the case of Bharat Petroleum (BPCL). Starting in early 2022, it set up EV Charging Stations along the Chennai- Tiruchirapalli – Madurai Highway, conveniently spaced 100 kms from each other to address the range discovery and time anxieties of electric vehicle owners on long distance drive. The 25 KW fast charger enabled customers to charge their EVs in about 30 minutes to travel upto 125 Km.

Since then, BPCL has electrified more than 5,000 kms of Highways across Kerala, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. CCS-2 Fast Chargers are also available at 12 strategically located BPCL Fuel Stations on the 750 Km long Delhi – Jalandhar National Highway. It has also created an e-network Pune-Ahmednagar-Aurangabad (240 KMs), Pune-Solapur (250 KMs), Pune- Nashik (200 KMs), Pune-Kolhapur (225 KMs), Mumbai-Nashik (200KMs) and Nashik - Shirdi (90 KMs). The Government has also been encouraging consumers to migrate to e-Vehicles with a slew of subsidies. The good news is that the end users are also eagerly taking to greener vehicles.

Electric bikes have become a common mode of daily transport among urban office-goers and daily commuters. In FY 2022, 231,338 units of electric bikes were sold in India. It is expected to reach 2,464,750 units in FY 2027, expanding at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of ~48.75% during the FY 2023 - FY 2027 forecast period. E-Rickshaws too have found a good traction. A total of 30,413 e-rickshaws were registered in February, up from 16,122 in the same month a year ago. People in India's cities and towns now take the environmentally friendly electric rickshaws, or e-rickshaws, instead of the traditional bicycle rickshaws.

Energy companies are entering into alliances to sweeten it further. BPCL has set up 66 Fast Chargers for e2-Wheelers with M/s Ola Electric and HeroMotoCorp. It has also set up 13 Battery Swapping Stations with M/s RACEnergy, VoltUp and Bounce. An Integrated Customer Program with MG Motors, enables EV customers to locate BPCL EV Charging stations through their car dashboards and fast charge their electric vehicles with specific benefits accorded to them.

With the new set of subsidies on electric vehicles and the government's thrust, the transportation sector is expected to quicken its march to a greener and cleaner tomorrow,in the near future. Leading India Energy Companies, like BPCL, are leading from the front, integrating their strategy, investments, environmental and social ambitions to move towards a sustainable planet. India is truly evolving as a trailblazer to create a dependable E-Ecosystem, paving the path to a clean future.